



Research Project

Citation & Research Software: Zotero

What is Zotero? How do I install it?

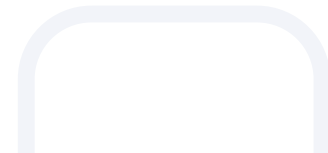
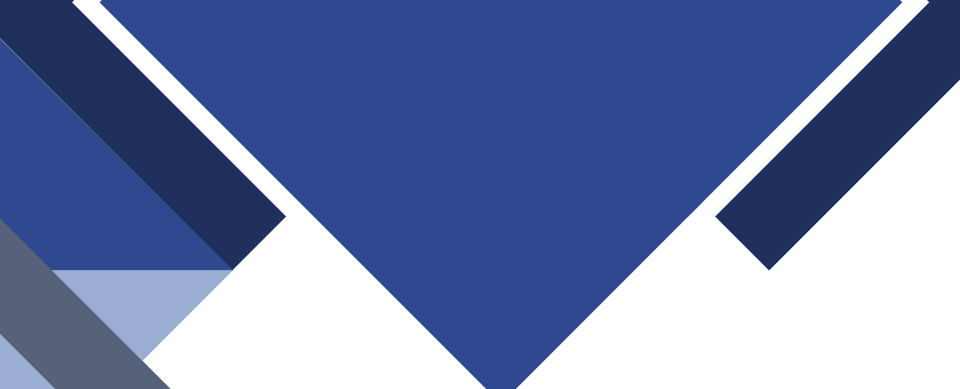
Zotero (zoh-TAIR-oh) is a reference manager that helps you collect, organise, cite and share your research sources such as books and articles.

1. Go to Zotero.org
2. Click the Download button for the app. The system will automatically recognise which operating system you are using.
3. From your Downloads folder, open the installation file.
4. Follow the installation prompts on your computer.
5. The app will be in your Programs or Applications folder.

We're about to watch a demonstration.

Follow along on your laptop and download the app!



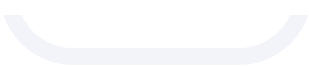


Did everyone successfully complete the following steps?

- 
- 
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If not, we'll pause for a couple minutes for you to download the app now!





Now we're going to install the Zotero Connector, which will allow you to add sources to your library while you're browsing Google Scholar (as we will this week).

1. Open the Zotero desktop app
2. Open Safari
3. From the Safari drop down menu, select Preferences.
4. In the Preferences pop-up window, choose the Extensions tab
5. In the left sidebar, check the Zotero Connector option
6. The Browser Connector icon should appear in the upper left bar of the Safari window
7. You can now search for and add sources to your Zotero Library

The Zotero Browser Connector for Safari is bundled with the Zotero app when it is downloaded and installed. The Zotero Connector for Safari requires at least Safari 15 on macOS 11 Big Sur or later.

Get in the Mindset of a Researcher!

- Curious
- Independent learner
- Passionate about or deep interest in a subject (or subjects)
 - STEM
 - Engineering, Physics, Mathematics, Computer Science, Biology, Chemistry
 - Social Sciences
 - Psychology, Economics, Political Science
 - Arts
 - History, Art, Music
 - Mixtures of these subjects: “Interdisciplinary”



Identify a Topic

- This can happen while bouncing around YouTube
- Watching a program
 - E.g. Discovery channel, Weather channel, etc
- Topic mentioned at school
- Topic mentioned by a mentor or a friend
 - Induce interesting discussions about the topic
 - Can draw your attention to some facet of the topic you are interested in.



Explore Web + Library Sources

Become very familiar with the current literature regarding the topic:

- Be voracious
- Understand what questions are being asked regarding your topic.
- Understand what unsolved problems experts are interested in solving.
- *Depth:* Develop knowledge and expertise in that specific area from the existing literature.
- *Immersion:* More knowledge leads to more understanding leads to more ideas for research.



Read Actively!

- Read the abstract of each paper first, then skim the introduction and conclusion to make sure it is useful.
- **Highlight** keywords and ideas that may be important to your research in each paper.
- Write questions in your notes or the margins.
- Email your professor with questions or look up the answers online.
- Write short summaries (1-3 sentences) of each article in your notes.

We'll return to this...

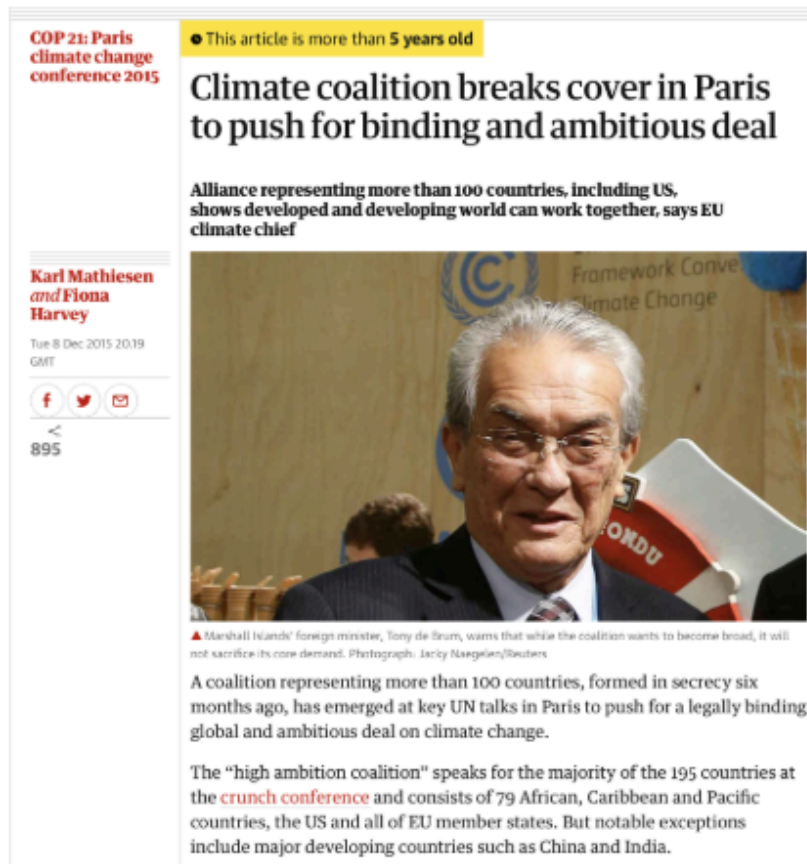
Get Comfortable With Research Tools!

- Make sure you have a good pdf annotation software. We'll review how to annotate in [Zotero](#) later today.
- [Google Scholar](#) for sources.
- Learn how to use [Latex](#)
- Latex cheats: no need to learn how to create tables, use the online table generator and simply copy paste it into your report: <https://www.tablesgenerator.com/>
- Same with flow charts, mathematical formulas etc thanks to Mathcha: <https://www.mathcha.io/editor>
- You may want to copy-paste your paper/report into grammarly before submitting: <https://www.grammarly.com/>

The Steps of a Scholarly Search

Interest Piqued by Media Article

1



Found an article in a reputable news source, where curiosity sparked our interest: **how is it that small states and non-state actors come to have a powerful role in climate negotiations?**

Google Scholar

2



Search **key terms** and reviewed open-sourced **academic literature**

Standard Google Search

3



Used a combination of **technical terms** found in those articles to make a **standard Google Search** and checked out one of the academics cited to **review** their **other research**

How to do a Basic Keyword Search: Part 1

1. Develop a list of keywords in your notes.
 - a. From your assigned articles (look at the abstract).
 - b. From your research question.
2. Type one or two keywords into Google Scholar.
 - a. Usually, a long list of references will pop up. Remain calm!
3. Filter the results:
 - a. Only peer-reviewed articles
 - b. Set a recent date range

How to do a Basic Keyword Search: Part 2

4. Sift through results for:
 - a. High profile journals (e.g. IEEE)
 - b. Well known authors or University responsible for an article
 - c. Skim the abstract to make sure the article is relevant
5. Download and skim it.
6. Use that article to play a game of bibliography tag!

PEER REVIEW



Published in a respected
peer-reviewed journal.



The resource appears on a
blog or **corporate website**.
There are bold claims not
backed up by evidence.



AUTHOR



The author is employed by a **respected university**, or appears frequently in mainstream media



The author has **no online record**



CONTENT



The resource is **well-written** and ordered, **cites** various literature, and contains **conclusions that emerge logically** from the main content.



The content is not written to excellent standards. The claims it makes seem **outlandish, grandiose or illogical**.



A Game of Bibliography Tag

Bibliography Tag: Step 1

Pick an article from your assigned reading! Then, skim it again.

Read actively: highlight and take notes on...

- Sources that are cited a lot in one article or in many articles. These are foundational articles in your field!
- More niche sources that offer information related to your research question.
- Footnotes next to sentences that intrigue you or make you curious to learn more.

Bibliography Tag: Step 2

Go to the bibliography of the paper that you just skimmed...

- Look up some of the sources that you listed in your notes.
- Notice:
 - Have you mostly taken note of review articles or empirical articles?
 - Are all of the articles that you selected clustering around a specific topic?
- Decide:
 - What article do you want to learn more about first.
 - You can use a more niche source to zoom in on your topic quickly.
 - Or you can use a review article to gain a better grounding in your field before zooming in on a topic!

Bibliography Tag: Step 3

Open Google Scholar!

- Paste the article title and author into the search bar.
- Find it in the results!
- Skim the abstract to see if it is actually relevant to your research.
- If it is useful...
 - Download it or email your course head Emily Chou for help.
 - Use the Zotero connector to add it to your Zotero library.
 - Write a sentence in your Zotero notes about why you think it might be useful for your project
- Decide:
 - Do you want to return to your first article and look up another source in your notes?
 - Or do you want to play Bibliography Tag using this article's sources to zoom further in on a specific topic?